

HYPERBOLE

Deliberate, extreme exaggeration



1 What is it?

Hyperbole (hy-PER-buh-lee)

Hyperbole is **deliberate, obvious exaggeration** — not meant to be taken literally — used to emphasise a feeling or make a point unforgettable.

ordinary statement → **EXTREME** version

2 See it in action

Hunger

I'm so hungry I could eat a horse.

Waiting

I've told you a million times to tidy your room.

Effort

That homework nearly killed me.

Speed

He ran so fast he must have broken the sound barrier.



Mfalme says...

Ask: "**could this statement possibly be true?**" If the answer is an obvious no, you've found hyperbole.

FUN FACT

Hyperbole is one of the oldest tricks in storytelling — ancient myths are full of it (giants, endless floods, seas parting) long before anyone wrote the word "hyperbole" down.

3 Why writers use it

Hyperbole helps writers: add humour, emphasise strong emotion, make a description far more memorable than the plain truth, and create a dramatic or comic tone.

Because hyperbole is so obviously untrue, the reader instantly understands it's about *feeling*, not fact — which is exactly what makes it work.

4 Where you'll spot it

Everyday exaggeration

"I'm dying of embarrassment" or "this bag weighs a tonne" — said dozens of times a day.

Stand-up comedy

Comedians blow ordinary situations wildly out of proportion for laughs.



Watch out!

Hyperbole must be **obviously exaggerated** — if a statement could actually be true, it's not hyperbole, it's just a fact (even an impressive one)!



Look here!

Hyperbole almost always signals **strong emotion** underneath — when you spot it, name the real feeling being exaggerated (frustration, excitement, exhaustion).

5 Quick recap

Extreme exaggeration

Not meant to be literal

Adds emphasis or
humour



You got this!

Try turning a boring sentence into a hyperbolic one — "I waited a while" becomes "I waited for **a thousand years.**"